AI EXPLAINED SIMPLY

The 5-Check AI Image Test

A quick routine to judge whether a picture was made by AI. No single check is proof: combine them, and accept "unknown" as an answer.

1. Hands and bodies

- Count the fingers. Look for fingers that are too long, too short, fused or missing.
- Check proportions: arms, necks, ears and teeth.

2. Text

- Zoom in on signs, labels, packaging and clothing. Garbled, warped or blended letters are a common tell.

3. Light and shadows

- Do all shadows fall in the same direction? Do reflections match the scene?
- Surfaces that look too smooth or too perfect deserve a second look.

4. Content Credentials and watermarks

- Open the file in the free Content Credentials verifier: verify.contentauthenticity.org
- If a record is there, it can show the tool and edits. If not, that proves nothing: a screenshot or re-upload erases it.
- Some AI tools also add invisible watermarks (for example Google's SynthID). A detector usually only recognises its own provider's watermark.

5. Reverse image search

- Upload the picture to Google Lens or TinEye. A real photo usually has earlier copies and a traceable source. An AI image often has none.

How to decide

- Several clear signs: very likely AI.
- No signs and a traceable source: likely real.
- Anything else: **unknown**. Do not share it as fact.

Sources

- CyberGuy: telltale signs of AI-created images
- Penplusbytes: how to detect AI-generated images
- C2PA Viewer: verify an AI-generated image
- Wikipedia: SynthID

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